EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Make order processing lighter — without replacing ERP

One focused workflow opportunity. A measured pilot. A staged investment decision.

RECOMMENDED BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY

Reduce avoidable manual effort in B2B order intake, validation and confirmation.

Proposed solution: configurable workflow + permitted connections to existing systems.

BOARD DECISION REQUEST

Approve discovery and the design of a bounded pilot — not unconditional three-market funding.

PILOT COHORT	PRIMARY OUTCOME	FIRST-MARKET HYPOTHESIS
Repeatable standard B2B orders	**Manual handling minutes / order**	**Denmark; readiness still TBD**

SOURCE: Competition brief, slides 8–12, 16, 18. All order-processing specifics are hypotheses; approval and benefits are not verified.

Four connected challenges — one investment priority

Company A: hundreds of stores across Denmark, Norway and Sweden; B2B and B2C customers.

01 **MANUAL PROCESSES**

Employee effort and inefficient repetitive tasks.

02 **INCONSISTENT OPERATIONS**

Different ways of working, uneven execution.

03 **DELIVERY & FULFILMENT**

Order and delivery challenges affect reliability.

04 **FRAGMENTED SYSTEMS**

Country-specific systems impede scaling improvements.

The case explicitly says impacts and urgency differ across markets.

A shared solution must not imply identical country implementation.

Separate case facts from root-cause hypotheses

Do not claim unobserved Company A processes or system interfaces as facts.

CONFIRMED IN BRIEF

CASE FACT

Markets evolved local systems and manual processes.

→

NEEDS WORKFLOW EVIDENCE

HYPOTHESIS

Disconnected data or unnecessary handoffs may create repeat work.

→

BASELINE REQUIRED

TESTABLE OUTCOME

Less active employee time per eligible order, with quality preserved.

Alternative business opportunities considered

A **Reduce manual order effort**

B **Improve store consistency**

C **Improve fulfilment reliability**

A targets one plausible intervention point; Fragmented Systems remains a potential cause, not a proven diagnosis.

A leads under a balanced, assumption-based matrix

Scores are decision-support judgments, not findings from Company A operational data.

CRITERION / WEIGHT		A • ORDER	B • STORES	C • DELIVERY
Business Impact	30%	**4/5**	**3/5**	**5/5**
Urgency	20%	**3/5**	**3/5**	**3/5**
Feasibility	20%	**3/5**	**4/5**	**2/5**
Time to Market	15%	**4/5**	**3/5**	**2/5**
Cross-market Scale	15%	**4/5**	**3/5**	**3/5**
WEIGHTED SCORE		**3.60**	**3.20**	**3.25**

WHY A: a smaller, testable workflow; C has greater theoretical impact but higher delivery risk. If integration fails, reassess A.

SOLUTION DESIGN

A reusable workflow capability; local systems stay authoritative

Design principle: REUSE BEFORE BUILD — extend existing tools first; add a layer only when needed.

Existing Order Systems
Order intake & authoritative status

↓

Permitted Country Integration
Data mapping, access, acknowledgement

↓

Shared Workflow Core
Rules • approvals • exception routing • audit

↓

Employee Workspace
Human checks and resolution

WHAT CHANGES

- Retrieve permitted data instead of re-keying
- Apply confirmed validation rules
- Route ambiguous cases to authorised staff
- Write back safely; audit outcomes
- Measure work across every affected role

NOT: ERP replacement or automatic approval for every order

OPTIONAL AI LATER: human-reviewed extraction of unstructured B2B purchase orders, only if this input format proves relevant.

FOCUSED MVP

Start with repeatable standard B2B orders

One eligible order cohort • one intake flow • a limited group • one market after readiness checks.

IN SCOPE

- Identify eligible orders; retrieve existing data
- Validate rules and route exceptions
- Approved confirmation + safe status update
- Audit trail, KPI instrumentation, recovery

OUT OF SCOPE

- Replace ERP / order management systems
- Warehouse, inventory and delivery optimisation
- All B2B/B2C order types or all markets
- Mandatory AI, fully autonomous approval

PRIMARY KPI

Active manual minutes / eligible order

−20% target is illustrative only

Guardrails: processing errors, rework/exception rate and no workload shifted to other teams.

Standardise the core. Localise what is necessary.

The case provides examples of differing priorities — not verified requirements for each country.

SHARED CORE • order lifecycle • validation pattern • exception routing • measurement & audit

DENMARK

First discovery candidate

Check manual-order workload, integration feasibility and pilot measurement.

NORWAY

Local operating differences

Check staff roles, store handoffs and approval variants.

SWEDEN

Local data & fulfilment interfaces

Check order-confirmation dependencies; do not expand scope into delivery.

Country rollout sequence is NOT confirmed. Select each wave using verified impact, technical readiness and change capacity.

Time to value needs gated implementation

Illustrative timeline from programme start — not a delivery commitment.

R0

DISCOVER

Weeks 1–2

Scope, baseline, readiness

R1

PREPARE

Weeks 3–8

Configure, integrate, UAT, train

R2

PILOT

Weeks 9–12

Controlled live use and collect data

R3

EVALUATE

Week 13+

Validate KPIs; scale / iterate / stop

DECISION GATES

01 Confirm pain + interface → 02 UAT + safety → 03 Measure value + quality → 04 Local readiness

Pilot staff, process owner, IT, information security and finance must own adoption, fallback and evidence collection.

ILLUSTRATIVE ECONOMICS

The base case is marginal — do not overstate ROI

Synthetic 3-country model. Not company volumes, vendor quotes or a funding forecast.

DOWNSIDE

−€536k

Lower volume / realisation

BASE

+€14k

Narrow positive nominal return

UPSIDE

+€292k

Requires optimistic assumptions

BASE FINANCIAL ASSUMPTIONS

12k eligible orders/wk • 12 min baseline • 20% saved
46 weeks/yr • €32/hour • 35% realised

3-YEAR NPV · 10% DISCOUNT RATE

−€39.5k

3-year model: €220k investment + €95k/year operating cost (base). Capacity ≠ cash savings. Benefit ramp: 30% / 80% / 100%.

BOARD DECISION

Approve learning, not an unverified three-country rollout

A credible consulting recommendation protects investment with explicit stop conditions.

RECOMMENDED NOW

Approve a capped discovery / pilot-design phase.

Proceed only if the team can demonstrate reducible manual work, safe system integration, measurable baseline and ownership.

CRITICAL GATES

- Evidence of avoidable work and eligible volume
- Authorised, reliable data and status updates
- No quality regression or shifted labour
- Country-specific rollout economics revalidated

IF THE DATA FAILS → ITERATE OR STOP. IF IT HOLDS → FUND A BOUNDED PILOT, THEN REASSESS SCALE.